



Civic Meeting Report

Delaware County Budget Hearings September 18th 2024 Segment #1

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VluCMslfzAU
Publication Date	2024-09-18T16:46:41Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Type: County Council Budget Hearing

Meeting Date: (As indicated in transcript proceedings)

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer [00:00:14](#) as a continuation of the County Council budget hearings. Discussions immediately focused on reviewing data points, salary leveling, job classifications, and departmental budget adjustments from the previous week.
- **Attendance:** Present members and staff identified in the dialogue include Council members (such as Bill, Jim, Eugene, and the presiding officer), municipal staff (Matt, Tanya, Jessica, Pam, and Rick), and various elected/department officials presenting their respective budgets.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Review of Previous Proceedings & Methodology** [00:00:20](#):

- Staff confirmed numbers were reconciled with Elizabeth Kan and Ke to ensure uniform data points.
- A “choose-your-own-adventure” spreadsheet/paper menu was distributed to council members to visually assess salary totals alongside Public Employees’ Retirement Fund (PERF) and FICA calculations.
- Clarification was provided regarding “leveling”: assigning a standard base salary to job classification buckets (e.g., Comet A, Comet B) independent of specific departments. Employees currently earning above the leveled base salary will have their pay frozen at their higher rate rather than reduced.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:05:58 Department Budgets & Salary Reviews (Chronological Order)

- **00:05:58 Courts & Legal Support Budgets:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Court Representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed court reporter positions, assistant court reporters, and master commissioners. Discussed adjustments for positions with or without longevity, aligning certain roles to midpoints versus base leveling.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Consensus to advance as reviewed with noted adjustments.
- **00:09:19 911 / Communications Department:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred (Communications/911 Director).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed communication technicians, supervisors, and the director’s position. Addressed complications regarding exempt versus non-exempt staff (overtime and holiday pay eligibility) and the integration of years-of-service steps (“experience matrix” / longevity equivalents).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote to set base salaries and establish experience matrix models for supervisors and dispatchers.
- **00:47:31 County Clerk Office & Record Perpetuation Fund:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Clerk Office Representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed deputy clerks, filing office classifications (Comet A, B, C, D), and job descriptions updated via the recent salary study. Reviewed base leveling at \$35,000 for Comet A and corresponding adjustments for Comet B/C/D positions, along with FICA and PERF recalculations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote with adjustments to line items and minor fund reallocations.
- **01:51:31 County Treasurer:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Treasurer).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed staff classifications, professional services (bank and attorney contract fees), and adjustments to ensure alignment with standardized leveling.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:53:55 County Recorder & Record Perpetuation Fund:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Recorder Office Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed line items, base adjustments for Comet B classifications, part-time lines, and statutory fund appropriations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:59:45 Sheriff Department & Jail Budgets:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Department Representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Comprehensive review of Merit deputies (buckets A through E), office managers, records clerks, and jail operations. Addressed the creation of a separate "Experience Matrix" line item to account for tenure/years of service instead of traditional longevity, and reviewed discrepancies in exempt supervisory roles.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Consensus to incorporate the experience matrix line and adjust totals accordingly.
- **02:43:42 County Surveyor & Surveyor Perpetuation Fund:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Surveyor Office Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Examined staff classifications, secretarial roles, and perpetuation fund FICA/PERF obligations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **02:54:39 Coroner's Office:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Coroner Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed operating reductions (including body bag and operating line items), 12-hour shift coverage, investigator roles, and chief deputy compensation relative to workload and on-call hours.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **03:04:14 County Assessor & Reassessment Funds:**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Assessor Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed chief deputy assessor, departmental staff, and reassessment budget totals. Addressed concerns regarding potential increases in employee health insurance costs outpacing minor tenure pay bumps.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **03:14:34 Prosecutor's Office (County General, LIT, & Diversion):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor Office Representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed corrected spreadsheets regarding LIT budget line items, investigators, chief investigators, and non-attorney staff. Discussed adjustments to base scales and longevity tracking.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote with minor adjustments to line items.
 - **03:34:11 Family Support (Title IV-D):**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Family Support Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed Comet D classifications, frozen salaries where current compensation exceeded base levels, and specific longevity allocations.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: No general citizen forum or open public comment period from members of the general public occurred during this administrative budget work session; discussions were strictly confined to council members, elected officials, and department heads.)

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Staff and council members noted that further departmental figures and experience matrix totals will be reviewed.
 - A tentative plan was established to reconvene following the regular meeting on Tuesday.
 - **Adjournment:** **03:50:10** The meeting was officially recessed / adjourned for lunch with instructions to return at 1:30 PM.
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